THE CHANGE-MAKERS

LEARNING MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS (LMS)

Software applications such as Sunbird, Wise App, WizIQ and TVS LMS provide the framework and platform to deliver online content to the users

EDTECH COMPANIES

Such as ByJu's, Unacademy, Ei Mindspark

₹32,820 CRORE

Projected value of the education technology sector in India by 2025

GOVERNMENT-BACKED MASSIVE OPEN ONLINE COURSES (MOOCS)

Students can access free web-based distance learning programmes such as Swayam and Diksha through the internet

multiplier. According to a report by McKinsey, students who had access to enough technology in their classrooms performed better than those who did not. In a study among teachers and principals of CBSE schools across North, West and South India, conducted by digital education firm Navneet TopTech, 24 per cent reported better learning outcomes because of technology. India is now the world's second-largest market for edtech, with a future valuation of around Rs 2.25 lakh crore.

by the Union cabinet to fast-track the BharatNet project will help here with its endeavour to provide fibreoptic connections to all villages. Public-private partnerships can also help build a robust digital infrastructure.

If technology has to revolutionise learning, reskilling of educators is a must. Currently, a vast majority of teachers lack a basic familiarity with digital technologies. Although NEP 2020 has stipulated teacher upskilling, its implementation requires a massive effort. Budgetary allocations for teachers' training fell from Rs 250

"The Sunbird-based platform DIKSHA connects digital content with textbooks and teacher training programmes. The Sunbird architecture helps create digital content from trusted institutions and academic boards, in one's local language, at one's convenience"



– NANDAN NILEKANI
Co-Founder & chairperson, EkStep Foundation

WHAT INDIA NEEDS TO MASTER

The learning disruptions during the Covid pandemic brought us a stark picture of how deep our digital divide is. Add to that poorly-trained educators, concerns over data privacy and exorbitant costs, and you see a gamut of challenges plaguing technology integration in education. Per a Union education ministry report, 55 per cent of Indian schools had no computer facilities. A study by Central Square Foundation—a non-profit organisation working in school education—among nearly 10,000 students in six states found that 40 per cent had never used technology for learning. The government must bridge this digital divide. The Rs 1.39 lakh crore recently approved

crore in 2021–22 to Rs 127 crore in 2022–23. There was no allocation under this head for the current fiscal.

While edtech firms and online sources have mushroomed, there has been no standardisation of the quality of content. Besides, edtech companies store student data, which raises data privacy concerns. The promise of self-regulation by the edtech industry has yet to materialise, with reports of malpractices and child rights violations on the rise. The Centre must bring in an edtech policy to regulate e-learning. Also, most private edtech products are unaffordable for low-income group students. The ministry must expand government-sponsored content. Edtech firms, educational institutions and the government must unite to optimise the effective use of technology. ■